> tent & played [with cards]. He had no clear recollection of any thing till the next morning very early still he was awakened by his *khansomma* [steward], a faithful man whom he kept all the time he was in India. He told this servant to count the money & take some of it. The man counted it & found nearly £2000. By a strange turn of luck my father had all but doubled his prize money.

During my travels in the Bangalore region I was frequently surprised to hear local people speaking warmly of Tipu. I could understand why local Muslims admired him, even to the point of veneration as a saint and martyr. But what I found mystifying was that Tipu Sahib should be seen by wider sections of the general community as a patriot who fought and died in a vain attempt to halt British imperialism in India.

After 1799 the EICo's policy of annexing local states was abandoned in favour of subsidiary alliances, by which the remaining Hindu kingdoms or Muslim-ruled areas in the South had accepted the suzerainty of the British monarch while remaining largely independent of the Government of India. These included the Hindu kingdoms of Mysore, Coorg (Kodagu), Travancore, Cochin, Pudukkottai and the tiny Maratha princedom of Sandur, the almost equally small Shia Muslim state of Banganapalle, and the Sunni Muslim state of Hyderabad and Berar – the second largest of all the Indian princely states and the richest, even if those riches were largely confined to its ruling Nizam and his nobility (see Map 8).

The main losers in Tipu's defeat and death were the Mappilas, many of whom had cast their lot with him and had been rewarded with land taken from Kodava, Nair and Nambudiri Brahmin landlords, which they were now forced to return with interest. The good relations that had long existed between them and their non-Muslim neighbours were replaced with enmity and suspicion on both sides. To